



9000 LHC cables

CERN has to identify and disconnect 9000 LHC cables to just plug in new ones because there is no space left. <http://digit.in/9000Cnt>



Robot room service

Future of having robots for everything is not too far as Savioke is aiming to launch its 'Robot' room service in US hotels. <http://digit.in/RoomSrv>

Bazaar

Microsoft Lumia 950XL

Riding into the danger zone

The Lumia 950XL is perhaps the most important product that Microsoft has launched over the past few years. One of the first phones to run Windows 10, Microsoft has a lot of hopes from this device. Unfortunately though, this isn't the phone that'll save Microsoft. The device has a polycarbonate body, and unlike the Lumia 920, 1020 and 930, this is nothing compared to flagship phones in the market today.

The plastic body simply looks and feels cheap for a phone that costs ₹49,399. While other Lumia devices, mentioned above, looked and felt like flagships, this phone feels like a sub-20k device. Compared to the Galaxy Note 5, iPhone, Moto X Force and many others that this phone competes with directly, the Lumia 950XL just doesn't belong.

The QHD display on the phone is as good as ever though. While you won't feel a big difference on the home and app screens, the higher pixel density (compared to older Lumias) shows when you're viewing content on the device. In addition, the Clearblack display is one of the best in terms of colour reproduction as well.

While the power of this device was never in question, the software is still not up to the mark if you want to play games. It's not as big an issue as the design, since gaming matters less on an enterprise device. The Lumia 950XL is much more responsive and fast as compared to older Microsoft flagships. In addition, the phone does really well in terms of call quality and reception.

The biggest problem with this phone though is also its best feature. While Continuum for Windows is good, you have to buy the Display Dock separately, which adds about ₹6000 to its overall price. In addition, while Universal Apps do work well on Continuum, there are very few of them actually available at the moment. Microsoft needs to ensure that the Windows Store is populated



Price
₹49,399

with new and useful Universal Apps as soon as possible.

Moving to the camera, the 20MP rear camera is perhaps the best part of the Lumia 950XL. It is faster than older Lumia smartphones and takes sharp and true to life images. The colour reproduction is really good and it is also very good in terms of low light image quality. The problem though is in the fact that most of these results come from the rich capture mode, which means you can still not depend on the Lumia completely, when it comes to the auto-mode. While the phone will take good images in the auto-mode, it often leaves you disappointed.

In addition, Windows Hello doesn't make up for the lack of a fingerprint sensor. At most times, the Iris Scanner takes too long to unlock the phone, which is neither intuitive, nor useful. When you're walking outdoor, Windows Hello will almost always keep asking you to 'move closer' and in low light conditions, it's almost useless.

The battery life on the Lumia 950XL has deteriorated as compared to older Lumia devices. While the battery life meets industry standards, you can't really depend on it to last a full day. It can go on for about 10 hours, which covers a regular work day, but if you're looking for more, then have a charger with USB-Type C support handy at all times.

Overall, the Microsoft Lumia 950XL is a good phone, but one that's really overpriced and will not be the phone to save Microsoft. It is an enterprise device, but even for enterprise customers, it can't really make up for its shortcomings. The app support needs to be sorted as soon as possible and Microsoft needs to look at a more modern and high-end design language. The lack of a fingerprint sensor on a device that costs nearly ₹50,000 is also a big issue.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.7 inch QHD;
Processor: Snapdragon 810 octa-core 64-bit; **RAM:** 3GB;
Storage: 32GB, expandable to 200GB; **Battery:** 3340 mAh; **Operating System:** Windows 10 Mobile

Contact

Microsoft
Phone: NA
Email: Contact form
Website: microsoft.com